

Settled in M

“Invoices should have a due date 15 days after they are created.”

Later instruction

“Add a reminder that gets sent 3 days before an invoice’s 30-day due date.”

The prompt requests a feature but assumes a different due date.

Consolidate-then-ask

The settled value may be replaced before the agent is asked whether a conflict exists.

Do-not-resolve

The conflicting values are kept separate for the user to decide.

Spec-guided

The settled value remains in the master prompt and the conflicting assumption is recorded.

Figure 5.1: The due-date conflict under the three experimental conditions.